

Assignment – Solving a Search Problem from Scratch (Up to A*)

Assignment Title

*From Problem Definition to A Search: Building an Intelligent Path-Finding Agent**

Problem Description

You are given a **grid-based map** representing a small city. An AI agent must move from a **start position (S)** to a **goal position (G)** while avoiding obstacles.

```
S  .  .  .  
#  #  .  #  
.  .  .  G
```

Legend:

- **S** = Start
- **G** = Goal
- **.** = Free cell
- **#** = Obstacle (cannot be crossed)

The agent can move **up, down, left, right**. Each move has a **cost of 1**.

Apply A* Step by Step

1. For each expanded state, compute:
 - $g(n)$
 - $h(n)$
 - $f(n) = g(n) + h(n)$
 2. Show which node A* selects at each step
 3. Stop when the goal is reached
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Expected Outcome

- A*: finds the **shortest path efficiently**
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Submission Requirements

- Python implementation of A*